

[OPEN DATA]

Austin Energy Budget Audit

Data and Management Transactions

Introduction and Info

Purpose: To understand how this company [Austin Energy] is managing on a budget scale that is used for operating and management needs within the energy company that is funded by customers and city taxpayers using data available on the open database through the city and Data.gov.

Background: The company [Austin Energy] serves electricity and other related energy resources and services to the City of Austin, Texas alongside with neighborhooding counties in the city metro region. With the rising demand in the population for its services in homes, businesses and institutions, there comes the need for the essential resources that are affecting both everyday and economic matters.

As the need for services and resources become more common for the energy company itself, it is also important to keep in note of how the company is operating on both fiscal and monetary scale in order to get specific resources that are reflected both the company and consumers on a business and government scale. Since many are paid by both customers and city taxpayers, these funds are used to provide energy quality through its needs of maintenance as well as installing new tools/equipment and transporting them in various ways alongside with business and labor within the present technology.

Through understanding **data analytics as well as the ability to query on basic accounting skills**, we can get an understanding on “behind the scenes” how the company manages its own energy services by storytelling and auditing specific open data budget datasheet(s) that will get a clue whether the company is meeting its expectations to its goals and constituents. We limited these on a sample size to 200 entities (rows) to narrow it down on the balance scale, but will expand if needed to get a better picture of the story.

Questions to Consider:

- How often does the energy company provide its services to its customers and stakeholders (including the city government alongside private energy partners)?
- What impacts does the energy company do to the customers, businesses and institutions on operating matters? How does the management provide what it needs for them?

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- **What ethical and management concerns should the company be in mind when it comes to tracking down budget and fiscal transactions from its employees and employers?**
- Given energy demand, how can the company provide better resources that are reflected based on short and long term holistic goals from financial, to geographical and business/management nature?

Sources:

[1]. City of Austin Operating Budget [OPEN DATA]

- Data.gov:
https://catalog.data.gov/dataset/program-budget-operating-budget-vs-expenditure-raw-data?from_hint=eyJxIjoieYnVkZ2V0Iiwic29ydCI6InJlbGV2YW5jZSJ9
- Official Data Portal:
https://data.austintexas.gov/Budget-and-Finance/Budget-Office-Program-Codes/du7k-5nxt/about_data

[2] Tong, C. (2026, June 18). Austin Energy Workers Cost the City \$37K through vehicle misuse, audit finds. *Austin American-Statesman*. Retrieved June 19, 2026. <https://www.statesman.com/news/article/austin-energy-city-vehicle-misuse-audit-22309660.php>.

[3] City of Austin, Austin City Auditor's Office. (2025, December). Austin Energy Fraud and Waste [Investigative Report]. pp. 1-17. https://austin.widen.net/view/pdf/xghlqntm1d/InvestigationReport_Austin_Energy_Fraud_Waste_December2025.pdf?t.download=true

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Outline Questions

A). Purpose of Transactions

- Count the specific expenses [expenditures] for each program, activity, unit, and the company as a whole are there during each fiscal year/quarter?
- For each sub-departments using the program, activity, unit and the budget-expense, what are they using the funds for? What is the idea about utilizing the resources listed on the sub-departments [also known as program]?

B). Budget and Expenses [Basic Accounting Query]

- What is the current total balance (of all categories) in this company [in this fiscal quarter and year]?
- For each three categories: company *program*, *activity-role* [see csv] and *specific unit/purpose* of the company transaction, what is the current balance for these transactions?
- Which transactions spend the most by each category [program, activity and unit] during the given fiscal year/quarter? [hint, the lower the balance is where it indicates which spends the most - see A]
- Which transactions spend the least by each category [program, activity and unit] during the given fiscal year/quarter? [hint, the higher the balance is where it indicates which spends less - see A]

NOTE: This requires using percentage of the usage of these expenses through the fiscal dashboard via Tableau Public.

C). Company Operations

- Which activities, programs and units used the most for this particular company?
- For each company role [by program and unit], what issues related to management and operations did this company encounter through *payment expenses*?
 - Example: In Company A, a specific sub-department role in facilities management had flexibility management issues due to the fact that there were not enough roles to perform with on-call troubleshooting requests because there were few workers available whereas the rest were on terminal or retirement leave.
- What are the roles of doing the sub-department roles through their activities, unit, and their transactions?
- List how many sub-department units [Units] are there for the company itself?